IELTS SPEAKING • TOPIC 26

BOOKS AND READING

Natural collocations • Advanced grammar structures • Sample answer

PART 1 • QUESTIONS

- Do you enjoy reading?
- What kind of books do you like?
- Do you prefer paper books or e-books?

PART 2 • CUE CARD

Describe a book you recently read.

You should say:

- what it was about
- why you chose it
- what you liked about it
- whether you would recommend it

PART 3 • QUESTIONS

- Are people reading less than before?
- Do e-books have advantages over paper books?
- How can parents encourage children to read?

50	12	62	124
collocations	structures	Band 8 stories	your sentences

START HERE

One plan for every “books and reading” card

- A book you recently read
- A book you read in your childhood
- A book that taught you something
- A book you would like to read
- An author you like
- A book you gave or received as a gift
- A place where you like to read
- A magazine or newspaper you read

What it is about → **Why** you chose it → **What** you liked about it → **Whether** you would recommend it

HOW TO READ EACH CARD

Tarjima + definition — o‘zbekcha ma’nosi va oddiy inglizcha izohi.

Band 8 story — iborani ro‘yxat emas, mini hikoya ichida ishlatish namunasi.

≈ Yaqin iboralar — shu ma’noga yaqin yana 2 ta natural ibora.

Qachon ishlatiladi — qaysi vaziyatda va qanday grammatika bilan.

Namuna gap — bitta tayyor gap. Keyin o‘zingiz 2 ta gap yozing.

Speaking ball — shu ibora gapirishda qanchalik foydali (10 dan).

10 / 10	Signature ibora: Band 8 ni ko‘rsatadi, ko‘p topiclarda ishlaydi.
8–9	Kuchli va moslashuvchan: tabiiy eshitiladi, ball oshiradi.
6–7	Foydali va ishonchli: asos sifatida yaxshi.
4–5	Vaziyatga bog‘liq yoki oddiyroq: faqat mos kelganda ishlating.

Describing a book and its story

COLLOCATIONS 1 / 5

1 a gripping plot

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

diqqatni o‘ziga tortadigan syujet • *a story so exciting that you want to keep reading*

BAND 8 STORY

The novel has **a gripping plot** that starts with a missing letter and ends in a family secret. I meant to read one chapter before bed, but I looked up and it was two in the morning.

≈ **an absorbing storyline** — o‘ziga singdirib oladigan voqealar

≈ **a fast-paced story** — tez rivojlanadigan hikoya

Qachon ishlatiladi: have / follow a gripping plot: Part 2 da kitob nima haqida ekanini jonli tasvirlash uchun. ‘Interesting story’ o‘rniga ishlating.

Namuna gap: Detective novels usually have **a gripping plot**, which is why I read them on long train journeys.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

2 a page-turner

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

qo‘ldan qo‘yib bo‘lmaydigan kitob • *a book so exciting that you read page after page quickly*

BAND 8 STORY

My aunt lent me **a page-turner** about a journalist chasing a corruption story. I finished all four hundred pages in a weekend, and my phone stayed forgotten in another room.

≈ **an unputdownable book** — uzilib o‘qiladigan kitob

≈ **a real thriller** — haqiqiy hayajonli asar

Qachon ishlatiladi: be a (real) page-turner: norasmiy, ijobiy ibora. Triller, detektiv va sarguzasht kitoblar uchun mos; ilmiy kitob uchun kam ishlatiladi.

Namuna gap: I don’t usually read thrillers, but this one is **a page-turner** that even my brother enjoyed.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

3 a thought-provoking read

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

o‘ylantiradigan asar • *a book that makes you think deeply about important ideas*

BAND 8 STORY

I expected an easy holiday novel, but it turned out to be **a thought-provoking read** about memory and loss. I kept stopping every few pages to think about my own grandparents’ stories.

≈ **an eye-opening book** — ko‘zni ochadigan kitob

≈ **a deep and meaningful book** — chuqur ma’noli kitob

Qachon ishlatiladi: a thought-provoking book / film / article: fikrlashga undaydi. Kitobning qiymatini ko‘rsatadigan kuchli sifat; Part 2 da ‘what you liked’ bandi uchun yaxshi.

Namuna gap: It’s **a thought-provoking read** that changed how I think about success.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

4 well-developed characters

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

yaxshi ochib berilgan qahramonlar • *characters whose personalities and feelings feel real and detailed*

BAND 8 STORY

What made the book special was its **well-developed characters**. By the middle, I knew how each one would react, and when the hero made a mistake, I felt as if a friend had let me down.

≈ **believable characters** — ishonarli qahramonlar

≈ **three-dimensional characters** — to‘laqonli, jonli qahramonlar

Qachon ishlatiladi: well-developed / complex / relatable characters: qahramonlar haqida gapirishda. ‘Good characters’ o‘rniga bundan foydalaning.

Namuna gap: I enjoy novels with **well-developed characters** more than ones that rely only on action.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

5 an unexpected twist

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

kutilmagan burilish • *a sudden surprising change in the story*

BAND 8 STORY

Everything seemed predictable until **an unexpected twist** in chapter ten changed who I thought the villain was. I actually gasped on the bus, and the lady next to me gave me a funny look.

≈ **a plot twist** — syujetdagi burilish

≈ **a surprise ending** — kutilmagan yakun

Qachon ishlatiladi: a twist (in the plot / at the end): hikoyaning kutilmagan o‘zgarishi. Spoilerni oldini olish uchun ‘without giving away the ending’ deb ayting.

Namuna gap: The book ends with **an unexpected twist** that makes you want to start again.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

6 is set in

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

(voqealar) ... da bo‘lib o‘tadi • *the story takes place in a particular time or place*

BAND 8 STORY

The novel **is set in** Bukhara in the 1920s, so the descriptions of the old bazaars and madrasas were fascinating. I could almost smell the spices as I turned the pages.

≈ **takes place in** — ... da sodir bo‘ladi

≈ **unfolds against the backdrop of** — ... fonida rivojlanadi

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO

(fe’l) maqsad qo‘ymoq, o‘rnatmoq — I **set** a goal to finish one book a week.

Qachon ishlatiladi: be set in + joy / davr: The story is set in... Passiv shaklda ishlatiladi; ‘is set at’ emas, ‘is set in’. Kitob yoki film tasvirida juda tabiiy.

Namuna gap: The film **is set in** a small mountain village, which gives the story a calm, nostalgic feel.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

7 a timeless classic

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

abadiy mumtoz asar • *an old, famous book that people still love because it never feels outdated*

BAND 8 STORY

My father kept pushing me to read **a timeless classic** by Alisher Navoi, and I resisted for years. When I finally did, I was shocked by how modern the feelings of the characters were.

≈ **a literary masterpiece** — adabiyot durdonasi

≈ **a work that stood the test of time** — vaqt sinovidan o'tgan asar

Qachon ishlatiladi: a timeless classic: eski, lekin hozir ham dolzarb asar. Part 1 da 'Do you read classics?' savoliga javob berishda mos keladi.

Namuna gap: Many young people ignore **timeless classics**, but they're often more exciting than modern bestsellers.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

8 vivid descriptions

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

jonli, ko'z oldiga keltiradigan tasvirlar • *details that help you picture a scene clearly in your mind*

BAND 8 STORY

The author's **vivid descriptions** of the desert were so detailed that I felt sand between my teeth. After finishing, I even checked photos online to see whether the real place looked as magical.

≈ **rich imagery** — boy obrazlilik

≈ **a picturesque setting** — chiroyli manzara

Qachon ishlatiladi: vivid descriptions / imagery / memories: jonli tasvir haqida. 'Colourful description' emas, 'vivid' ishlating.

Namuna gap: I love books with **vivid descriptions** because they make me feel as if I'm travelling.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

9 based on a true story

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

haqiqiy voqeaga asoslangan • *created from real events that happened to real people*

BAND 8 STORY

The book is **based on a true story** about a woman who rebuilt her village after an earthquake. Knowing that she really existed made every difficult chapter hit me harder.

≈ **inspired by real events** — haqiqiy voqealardan ilhomlangan

≈ **a true-life account** — hayotiy hikoya

Qachon ishlatiladi: be based on + a true story / real events. 'Based from' deb yozmang. Kitob yoki film haqida ishonchlilik va ta'sirni oshiradi.

Namuna gap: I prefer novels **based on a true story** because I feel I learn something real from them.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

10 deals with

7/10
SPEAKING BALL

(kitob) ... mavzusini yoritadi • *is about a serious topic or problem and explores it*

BAND 8 STORY

The novel **deals with** the struggles of a young teacher in a remote village. It never feels preachy, though; the author simply shows daily life, and the message comes through quietly.

≈ **explores the theme of** — ... mavzusini chuqur o‘rganadi

≈ **tackles the issue of** — ... muammosiga to‘xtaladi

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO

(fe’l) uddalamoq, bardosh bermoq — How do you **deal with** stress before exams?

Qachon ishlatiladi: deal with + mavzu: The book deals with love / loss / identity. Jiddiy mavzular uchun; ‘talks about’ dan ko‘ra adabiy tuyuladi.

Namuna gap: The documentary **deals with** climate change in a very personal way.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

11 an avid reader

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

ishtiyoqli kitobxon • *a person who reads a lot and enjoys it very much*

BAND 8 STORY
I've been **an avid reader** since primary school, when my mum read bedtime stories to me every night. Now I always carry a paperback in my bag, just in case I get stuck in a queue.

≈ **a keen reader** — g'ayratli kitobxon

≈ **a voracious reader** — to'xtovsiz o'qiydigan kitobxon

Qachon ishlatiladi: be an avid reader / fan / collector. 'Avid' kuchli ishtiyoqni bildiradi. 'Do you enjoy reading?' savoliga javobda ibora sifatida ishlating.

Namuna gap: My sister is **an avid reader**, so her room looks more like a small library.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

12 a bookworm

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

kitobxo'r • *someone who loves reading and spends a lot of time with books*

BAND 8 STORY
As a child I was such **a bookworm** that my parents had to take my torch away at night. I used to hide under the blanket just to finish one more chapter.

≈ **a book lover** — kitob sevar

≈ **someone who's always got their nose in a book** — doim kitobga cho'mib o'tiradigan odam

Qachon ishlatiladi: a bookworm: norasmiy, mehr bilan aytiladigan so'z; o'zingiz haqingizda hazil bilan ishlatsangiz yaxshi. Rasmiy esseda 'avid reader' ma'qulroq.

Namuna gap: I'm a bit of **a bookworm**, so a rainy weekend with a good novel is my idea of paradise.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

13 curl up with a book

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

kitob bilan qulay joylashib olmoq • *to sit comfortably in a relaxed position and read*

BAND 8 STORY
After a noisy week, nothing beats the chance to **curl up with a book** on the sofa. I make a pot of green tea, switch off my phone, and the whole evening feels like a holiday.

≈ **settle down with a novel** — romanni qo'lga olib joylashmoq

≈ **snuggle up with a good read** — yaxshi kitob bilan qulaylashmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: curl up with + a book / a cup of tea: dam olish va qulaylikni bildiradi. Part 1 dagi 'Where do you like to read?' savoliga mos.

Namuna gap: In winter I love to **curl up with a book** by the heater and forget about the cold.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

14 get lost in a book

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

kitobga sho‘ng‘ib ketmoq • *to be so interested in a book that you forget everything around you*

BAND 8 STORY

When I started this novel, I told myself I’d read for ten minutes. I **got lost in the book** so completely that I missed my metro stop and had to walk home in the rain.

≈ **be absorbed in a story** — hikoyaga to‘liq singib ketmoq

≈ **be engrossed in a novel** — romanga to‘la berilib ketmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO

(buyruq) yo‘qol! (qo‘pol) — ‘**Get lost!**’ he shouted when I teased him about his haircut.

Qachon ishlatiladi: get / be lost in + a book / music / thought: butun e’tiborni berish. Ijobiy ma’noda ishlatiladi; ‘lost’ deganda adashishni ham anglatishi mumkin.

Namuna gap: It’s easy to **get lost in a book** when the author describes places so vividly.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

15 I couldn’t put it down

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

qo‘limdan qo‘ya olmadim • *the book was so exciting that you didn’t want to stop reading*

BAND 8 STORY

I started the book on Friday night, and **I couldn’t put it down**. By Sunday evening I’d read it twice as fast as I normally read, and my eyes were tired but I was smiling.

≈ **I was hooked** — kitob meni o‘ziga tortib oldi

≈ **I devoured it** — uni tez va ishtiyoq bilan o‘qib chiqdim

Qachon ishlatiladi: can’t put it down / couldn’t put it down: kitob juda qiziqarli bo‘lganini aytadi. ‘Couldn’t stop’ dan ko‘ra tabiiyroq.

Namuna gap: I’d say it’s one of those novels that **you can’t put down** once you’ve started.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

16 read from cover to cover

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

boshidan oxirigacha o‘qib chiqmoq • *to read the whole book from the first page to the last*

BAND 8 STORY

I rarely finish books, but this one I **read from cover to cover** in three days. Even the author’s notes at the end were interesting, so I couldn’t skip anything.

≈ **read it in one sitting** — bir o‘tirishda o‘qib chiqmoq

≈ **finish it in a single go** — bir yo‘la tugatmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: read something from cover to cover: to‘liq o‘qish. Yarim-yartilab o‘qiganingiz bilan farqli ravishda ‘skim’ deyiladi.

Namuna gap: Our teacher asked us to **read the novel from cover to cover** before the next class.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

17 skim through

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

ko‘z yugurtirib, tez o‘qib chiqmoq • *to read quickly just to get the general idea*

BAND 8 STORY

In a bookshop I always **skim through** a few pages before buying anything. If the first chapter doesn’t pull me in within minutes, I put it back, however beautiful the cover is.

≈ **flick through** — varaqlab ko‘rmoq

≈ **glance over** — ko‘z yugurtirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: skim through + ot: tez va yuzaki o‘qish. Imtihon matnlarida ham foydali ko‘nikma; ‘skim’ faqat umumiy fikrni olishga qaratilgan.

Namuna gap: I usually **skim through** the reviews before deciding whether a book is worth my time.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

18 dip into

5/10 SPEAKING BALL

oz-ozdan, ixtiyoriy joyidan o‘qib turmoq • *to read a little of a book from time to time without hurrying*

BAND 8 STORY

I keep a book of short stories by my bed and **dip into** it when I can’t sleep. Each tale takes ten minutes, so I never feel guilty about stopping halfway.

≈ **read it in bits and pieces** — ozdan-ozdan o‘qimoq

≈ **browse through** — ko‘zdan kechirib o‘qimoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: dip into + a book: kitobni boshdan oxirigacha emas, oz-ozdan o‘qish. Qisqa hikoyalar va ensiklopediya uchun ayniqsa mos.

Namuna gap: It’s a heavy history book, so I just **dip into** a chapter at weekends.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

19 lose track of time

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

vaqt o‘tganini sezmay qolmoq • *to forget how much time has passed because you’re so interested*

BAND 8 STORY

When I read in the library, I often **lose track of time**. Last week the librarian had to tell me it was closing, and I couldn’t believe four hours had gone by.

≈ **not notice the hours passing** — soatlar o‘tganini sezmaslik

≈ **be completely absorbed** — butunlay berilib ketmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: lose track of time: yoqimli mashg‘ulotga berilib vaqtni unutish. Teskarisi: keep track of time. Part 1 va Part 2 uchun juda foydali.

Namuna gap: I **lose track of time** whenever I open a good book at the café.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

20 make time for reading

7/10
SPEAKING BALL

o‘qishga vaqt ajratmoq • *to deliberately find time in a busy schedule to read*

BAND 8 STORY

I’m busy, but I **make time for reading** before sleep, even if it’s only fifteen minutes. That small habit has helped me finish about two books a month without feeling pressured.

≈ **set aside time to read** — o‘qish uchun vaqt ajratmoq

≈ **fit reading into my day** — o‘qishni kun tartibiga sig‘dirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: make time for + ot / V-ing: bandligingizga qaramay vaqt topish. ‘Find time’ ham to‘g‘ri, lekin ‘make time’ qat’iy qaror borligini ko‘rsatadi.

Namuna gap: If you really want to improve, you have to **make time for reading** every single day.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

21 come highly recommended

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

juda yuqori baholab tavsiya etilgan • *to be praised strongly by people whose opinion you trust*

BAND 8 STORY
The book **came highly recommended** by three different teachers, so I decided to give it a try. I'd never have chosen it myself because of the boring cover, which shows why recommendations matter.

≈ **be widely praised** — keng maqtalgan bo'lmoq

≈ **get glowing reviews** — iliq sharhlar olmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: come highly recommended (by sb): kimdir qattiq tavsiya qilgan narsa haqida. Kitob tanlash sababini tushuntirishda (cue card 'why you chose it') juda mos.

Namuna gap: I tried the restaurant because it **came highly recommended** by my neighbour.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

22 browse the shelves

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

javonlarni ko'zdan kechirmoq • *to look through books in a shop or library without a fixed plan*

BAND 8 STORY
On Sundays I like to **browse the shelves** at the old bookshop near the bazaar. I rarely look for anything specific, and half my favourite books were simply found this way.

≈ **wander around a bookstore** — kitob do'konini aylanib yurmoq

≈ **look through the stacks** — kitob qatorlarini ko'zdan kechirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: browse the shelves / browse the web: shoshilmay ko'zdan kechirish. Biror kitobni aniq qidirish uchun emas, 'look for' deyiladi.

Namuna gap: I could **browse the shelves** for hours and still not feel bored.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

23 judge a book by its cover

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

kitobni muqovasiga qarab baholamoq • *to form an opinion about something only from how it looks*

BAND 8 STORY
I know I shouldn't **judge a book by its cover**, but the bright orange design made me pick it up. Luckily, the story inside was just as bold and colourful.

≈ **go by appearances** — tashqi ko'rinishga qarab baholamoq

≈ **make a snap judgement** — shoshilinch xulosa chiqarmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Maqol: Don't judge a book by its cover = tashqi ko'rinishga qarab baho berma. Kitob mavzusida kulgili va tabiiy, ko'pincha inkor shaklida qo'llanadi.

Namuna gap: People say you shouldn't **judge a book by its cover**, but honestly a good design catches my eye.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

24 pick up a copy of

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

(kitobning) bir nusxasini sotib olmoq, olmoq • *to buy or take a book, often quickly and without much planning*

BAND 8 STORY

I **picked up a copy of** the novel at the airport because my flight was delayed. By the time we boarded, I was already on page eighty and secretly hoping for another delay.

≈ **get hold of a copy** — kitobning bir nusxasini topib olmoq

≈ **grab a copy** — bir nusxasini olib qo'ymoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO

(fe'l) o'rganib olmoq (ko'nikma, til) — I **picked up** some Turkish just by watching dramas.

Qachon ishlatiladi: pick up a copy of + kitob: do'kondan, kutubxonadan yoki do'stdan olish. Norasmiy va juda keng tarqalgan ibora.

Namuna gap: If you see the book in a shop, **pick up a copy** immediately because it sells out fast.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

25 check out a book

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

kutubxonadan kitob olmoq • *to borrow a book from a library*

BAND 8 STORY

At university I **checked out** at least five books a week from the library. It was free, and the librarian started recommending new titles because she recognised my reading taste.

≈ **borrow a book** — kitob qarzga olmoq

≈ **take a book out** — kitobni olib chiqmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO

(fe'l) qiziqib ko'rib chiqmoq — You should **check out** this podcast about history; it's brilliant.

Qachon ishlatiladi: check out + a book: kutubxonadan olish (amerika ingliz tilida ko'proq). Britaniyada 'take out' yoki 'borrow' ham ishlatiladi.

Namuna gap: I usually **check out** two or three novels before the holidays.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

26 a second-hand copy

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

ikkinchi qo'l kitob • *a book that someone else has owned and read before*

BAND 8 STORY

I found **a second-hand copy** of my favourite novel at the Sunday market for almost nothing. It had notes in the margins from a previous owner, which made reading it feel like a conversation with a stranger.

≈ **a used book** — ishlatilgan kitob

≈ **a pre-loved paperback** — avval o'qilgan yumshoq muqovali kitob

Qachon ishlatiladi: a second-hand copy / second-hand books: ishlatilgan kitob. Tejamkorlik yoki bozor haqida gapirganda juda tabiiy.

Namuna gap: I'd rather buy **a second-hand copy** and spend the money I saved on more books.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

27 leave a lasting impression

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

chuqur, uzoq esda qoladigan iz qoldirmoq • *to make a strong effect on someone that they remember for a long time*

BAND 8 STORY

The final chapter **left a lasting impression** on me. Weeks later, I still found myself thinking about the main character's choice whenever I had to make a difficult decision.

≈ **stay with me** — xotiramda qolmoq

≈ **make a deep impact** — chuqur ta'sir qoldirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: leave a lasting impression on + kishi: Part 2 da kitob sizga qanday ta'sir qilganini aytish uchun. 'Make a deep impression' ham to'g'ri.

Namuna gap: Some books **leave a lasting impression** because they change how we see the world.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

28 rave reviews

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

juda maqtovli sharhlar • *extremely positive opinions about a book or film in the media*

BAND 8 STORY

The book received **rave reviews** online, so my expectations were sky-high. Thankfully, it didn't disappoint, and I ended up recommending it to every classmate who would listen.

≈ **glowing reviews** — iliq sharhlar

≈ **critical acclaim** — tanqidchilar e'tirofi

Qachon ishlatiladi: get / receive rave reviews: ommaviy ravishda maqtalgan asar. 'Good comments' demang; 'reviews' eng to'g'ri so'z.

Namuna gap: The new film has been getting **rave reviews** from critics and ordinary viewers alike.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

29 live up to expectations

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

umidlarni oqlamoq • *to be as good as people hoped or expected*

BAND 8 STORY

Everyone told me the book was amazing, so I was nervous that it wouldn't **live up to** my **expectations**. By page fifty, I knew my worries were pointless; it was even better than they'd promised.

≈ **meet my expectations** — kutganimdek chiqmoq

≈ **exceed my expectations** — umidimdan ham oshib tushmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: live up to + expectations / hype / reputation. Ko'pincha 'It didn't live up to the hype' tarzida, ya'ni kutilganidek chiqmadi, deb ishlatiladi.

Namuna gap: The sequel didn't quite **live up to** the **expectations** created by the first book.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

30 a must-read

7/10
SPEAKING BALL

albatta o‘qish kerak bo‘lgan kitob • *a book that everyone should read because it’s so good or important*

BAND 8 STORY

If you’re interested in personal growth, this book is **a must-read**. It’s short, honest and practical, so I’ve already lent it to my cousin and two classmates.

≈ **an essential read** — zarur kitob

≈ **a book not to be missed** — o‘tkazib yuborib bo‘lmaydigan kitob

Qachon ishlatiladi: be a must-read (for + guruh): kitobni tavsiya qilishda (cue card dagi ‘would you recommend it?’). Yana: a must-see (film), a must-try (taom).

Namuna gap: For anyone learning English, this vocabulary book is **a must-read**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

31 broaden my horizons

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

dunyoqarashimni kengaytirmoq • *to give you new ideas, experiences and ways of seeing the world*

BAND 8 STORY
Reading novels from other countries **broadens my horizons** more than any school lesson. After one story about life in Japan, I started asking my classmates much more curious questions about different cultures.

≈ **open my mind** — fikrimni ochmoq

≈ **widen my outlook** — qarashlarimni kengaytirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: broaden / expand + one's horizons: kitob, sayohat yoki yangi tajriba foydasini tushuntirishda. 'Horizons' doim ko'plikda va 'my' bilan keladi.

Namuna gap: Travelling and reading both **broaden my horizons** in completely different ways.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

32 expand my vocabulary

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

so'z boyligimni oshirmoq • *to learn many new words and use them in speaking or writing*

BAND 8 STORY
Reading in English is the best way to **expand my vocabulary**. I underline new phrases in pencil, and the next week I try to use at least three of them while chatting with my friends.

≈ **enrich my vocabulary** — so'z boyligimni boyitmoq

≈ **pick up new words** — yangi so'zlarni o'rganib olmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: expand / build / enrich + vocabulary. IELTS Speaking da o'qishning foydasi haqida gapirganda juda ishlaydi; 'increase words' demang.

Namuna gap: Podcasts and novels are great tools to **expand your vocabulary** naturally.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

33 see things from a different perspective

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

narsalarga boshqa nuqtai nazardan qaramoq • *to understand a situation by imagining how someone else sees it*

BAND 8 STORY
The story was told by a child, so I could **see** the war **from a different perspective**. It made me realise how rarely I listen to young people before forming an opinion.

≈ **look at it from another angle** — boshqa burchakdan qaramoq

≈ **put myself in someone's shoes** — o'zimni birovning o'rniga qo'ymoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: see things / look at things from a different perspective / point of view. Part 3 da fikr bildirishda juda foydali; 'in another view' demang.

Namuna gap: Books let us **see things from a different perspective** without leaving our armchair.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

34 escape from reality

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

voqelikdan qochmoq • *to forget real-life problems by enjoying a story or fantasy*

BAND 8 STORY

After a stressful exam week, fantasy novels let me **escape from reality** for a few hours. I forget my worries and travel with dragons and wizards instead.

≈ **switch off from the real world** — real dunyodan uzilmoq

≈ **get away from it all** — hamma narsadan chetga chiqmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: escape from / escape + reality / daily life: dam olish va ko‘ngilochar o‘qish haqida. Ba’zan salbiy ma’noda ham keladi (haddan ortiq qochish).

Namuna gap: Reading is my way to **escape from reality** when life becomes too hectic.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

35 take my mind off

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

xayolimni chalg‘itmoq, o‘ylarimdan chalg‘itmoq • *to stop you from thinking about something that worries you*

BAND 8 STORY

Before my driving test I couldn’t sit still, so I opened a funny novel to **take my mind off** it. Within a few pages I was laughing, and my nerves disappeared much faster than I expected.

≈ **distract me from** — meni ... dan chalg‘itmoq

≈ **clear my head** — boshimni tozalamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: take my mind off + ot / V-ing (worries, work, the exam): tashvishdan chalg‘itish. ‘Take off my mind’ deb so‘z tartibini buzmang.

Namuna gap: A good book is the best way to **take my mind off** a busy day.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

36 food for thought

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

o‘ylantiradigan fikr, mulohaza uchun ozuqa • *an idea that makes you think carefully about something*

BAND 8 STORY

The author’s views on friendship gave me real **food for thought**. I ended up discussing the book with my mother for an hour, and we discovered we completely disagreed about one character.

≈ **something to chew over** — o‘ylab ko‘rish uchun mavzu

≈ **a thought-provoking idea** — o‘ylantiradigan g‘oya

Qachon ishlatiladi: give someone food for thought / be food for thought: Part 2 va 3 da kitob yoki fikr o‘ylantirishini aytish uchun. Sanalmaydigan ot.

Namuna gap: The documentary gave me a lot of **food for thought** about how we use technology.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

37 learn a valuable lesson

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

qimmatli saboq olmoq • *to understand something important that will help you in the future*

BAND 8 STORY

From this novel I **learnt a valuable lesson** about patience. The hero fails many times before succeeding, and that reminded me not to panic when my own plans don't work immediately.

≈ **take away an important message** — muhim xulosa olib ketmoq

≈ **gain real insight** — chuqur tushuncha olmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: learn a valuable / important lesson (about + ot / from + ot): tajribadan olingan foyda. 'Learn lesson' emas, artikl 'a' ni unutmang.

Namuna gap: Children **learn valuable lessons** from stories about honesty and courage.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

38 spark my imagination

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

tasavvurimni uyg'otmoq • *to make you start thinking creatively and imagining new things*

BAND 8 STORY

As a child, folk tales about brave heroes **sparked my imagination**. I used to draw maps of imaginary kingdoms, and I think that's why I still enjoy writing stories today.

≈ **fire my imagination** — tasavvurimni alangalatmoq

≈ **stimulate my creativity** — ijodkorligimni rag'batlantirmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO

(fe'l) sabab bo'lmoq (bahs, qiziqish) — The new law **sparked** a heated debate in our class.

Qachon ishlatiladi: spark + imagination / interest / curiosity / a debate. Bolalik xotiralari va ijod haqida gapirganda ayniqsa mos keladi.

Namuna gap: Picture books **spark** children's **imagination** before they even learn to read.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

39 strike a chord with

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

qalbga yetib bormoq, his-tuyg'uga ta'sir qilmoq • *to make you feel that something is true and important to you*

BAND 8 STORY

The main character's fear of disappointing his parents **struck a chord with** me. I'd felt exactly the same before my entrance exams, and reading it made me feel less alone.

≈ **resonate with me** — menga yaqin bo'lib tuyulmoq

≈ **hit home** — yurakka tegmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO

(fe'l) (soat) chalmoq — The clock **struck** midnight, but I was still reading.

Qachon ishlatiladi: strike a chord with + kishi: kitob yoki qo'shiq o'z his-tuyg'ularingizga mos kelganida. Part 2 dagi 'what you liked about it' bandida yaxshi ishlaydi.

Namuna gap: Her speech **struck a chord with** thousands of young readers.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

40 open my eyes to

8/10
SPEAKING BALL

ko‘zimni ochmoq (haqiqatga) • *to make you notice or understand something you didn’t realise before*

BAND 8 STORY

This book **opened my eyes to** how much plastic we throw away. The next day, I started carrying a cloth bag to the bazaar, and my neighbours noticed the difference.

≈ **make me aware of** — meni ... dan xabardor qilmoq

≈ **give me a new insight into** — ... ga yangicha nazar bergan

Qachon ishlatiladi: open someone’s eyes to + ot: yangi haqiqatni anglatish. ‘Eye-opening‘ (sifat) ham juda mashhur: an eye-opening book.

Namuna gap: Travelling alone **opened my eyes to** how many different lifestyles exist.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

Part 3: reading trends and children

COLLOCATIONS 5 / 5

41 a decline in reading

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

o'qishning kamayishi • *a gradual fall in how much people read books*

BAND 8 STORY

Teachers have noticed **a decline in reading** among teenagers over the last decade. Many of my classmates admit they haven't finished a book since school started, preferring short videos instead.

≈ **a drop in readership** — kitobxonlar sonining kamayishi

≈ **fewer people reading** — kamroq odam o'qishi

Qachon ishlatiladi: a decline / drop in + ot (reading, sales, interest). Part 3 da 'Are people reading less?' savoliga javob berishda ishlatiladi.

Namuna gap: There has been **a decline in reading** among young people, mainly because of social media.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

42 a short attention span

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

qisqa diqqat doirasi • *the ability to concentrate on something for only a very short time*

BAND 8 STORY

Constant notifications give us **a short attention span**, and that makes long novels feel exhausting. I've noticed that I can scroll for an hour but struggle to read five pages in silence.

≈ **trouble concentrating** — diqqatni jamlashda qiyinchilik

≈ **limited focus** — cheklangan e'tibor

Qachon ishlatiladi: have a short attention span: diqqat qisqa bo'lganida. Part 3 da texnologiyaning o'qishga ta'siri haqida; 'weak attention' demang.

Namuna gap: Teenagers with **a short attention span** often prefer videos to books.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

43 instant gratification

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

darhol qoniqish olish • *getting pleasure or reward immediately instead of waiting*

BAND 8 STORY

Social media offers **instant gratification**, because every swipe brings something new. Books, however, reward patience, and I think that's why many people find them harder than a quick video.

≈ **quick rewards** — tez mukofotlar

≈ **immediate pleasure** — bir zumda olingan zavq

Qachon ishlatiladi: instant gratification: sabr talab qilmaydigan zavq. Texnologiya, ovqatlanish va xarid odatlarini muhokama qilganda kuchli Part 3 ibora.

Namuna gap: Our culture of **instant gratification** makes it harder to enjoy slow, long books.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

44 instil a love of reading

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

kitobga muhabbat uyg‘otmoq • *to help a child slowly grow to enjoy reading*

BAND 8 STORY
My grandfather **instilled a love of reading** in me by telling cliffhanger stories each night and stopping at the best part. I’d beg for the next evening, then run to the library to find the ending myself.

≈ **foster a reading habit** — o‘qish odatini tarbiyalamoq

≈ **nurture a passion for books** — kitobga ishtiyoqni o‘stirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: instil a love of + ot in + kishi: bolalarga kitobga muhabbat singdirish. Part 3 da ‘How can parents encourage children to read?’ savoliga javob uchun.

Namuna gap: Schools should **instil a love of reading** instead of forcing children to memorise summaries.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

45 read aloud to

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

(birovga) ovoz chiqarib o‘qib bermoq • *to read a book out loud so that someone else can listen*

BAND 8 STORY
Every evening, my aunt **reads aloud to** her young son, doing different voices for every character. He’s only five, but he already begs for one more chapter before he’ll go to sleep.

≈ **read bedtime stories to** — uxlashdan oldin ertak o‘qib bermoq

≈ **share stories with** — ... bilan hikoyalarni ulashmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: read aloud to + bola: ovoz chiqarib o‘qish. Parents should read aloud to their children every day. ‘Read loudly’ demang, bu ovozi baland degani.

Namuna gap: Parents who **read aloud to** their children give them a strong start in literacy.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

46 lead by example

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

o‘rnak bo‘lmoq • *to behave in the way you want others to behave, so they follow you*

BAND 8 STORY
If parents want their children to read, they should **lead by example**. In our house, the TV goes off at eight, and my parents pick up their books, which made me copy them naturally.

≈ **set a good example** — yaxshi o‘rnak bo‘lmoq

≈ **practise what you preach** — aytgan gapingizga amal qilmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO
(fe’l) olib bormoq, yetaklamoq — This path **leads** to the old library behind the park.

Qachon ishlatiladi: lead by example: Part 3 da ota-ona, o‘qituvchi, rahbar haqida. Predlog ‘by’ bilan keladi: ‘lead with example’ xato.

Namuna gap: Teachers who read for pleasure **lead by example** and inspire their students.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

47 easy access to

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

... ga oson kirish imkoni • *the ability to reach or use something without difficulty*

BAND 8 STORY

Digital libraries give students **easy access to** thousands of books, even in remote villages. My cousin lives far from a big city, yet he reads more than I do thanks to his e-reader.

≈ **convenient access to** — ... dan qulay foydalanish

≈ **unlimited access to** — cheksiz foydalanish imkoni

Qachon ishlatiladi: have easy access to + ot: oson foydalanish. 'Access' dan keyin 'to' ni unutmang: access to books, 'access books' ham mumkin lekin kam. Part 3 da texnologiya foydasini aytishda.

Namuna gap: E-books provide **easy access to** reading material for people everywhere.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

48 a whole library in your pocket

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

cho'ntagingizdagi butun kutubxona • *the idea that an e-reader or phone can hold hundreds of books*

BAND 8 STORY

My e-reader is like **a whole library in your pocket**. On my last trip I carried two hundred titles in a device lighter than one paperback, which saved my back and my luggage allowance.

≈ **a portable bookshelf** — ko'chma kitob javoni

≈ **thousands of books at your fingertips** — minglab kitob qo'l ostida

Qachon ishlatiladi: E-kitoblarning afzalligini obrazli aytish: an e-reader gives you a whole library in your pocket. Part 3 da 'Do e-books have advantages?' savoliga javob berishda.

Namuna gap: With an app like this, you've got **a whole library in your pocket** wherever you go.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

49 a tactile experience

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

teginish orqali olinadigan tajriba • *the feeling you get from touching and holding a physical object*

BAND 8 STORY

I still love paper books because reading them is **a tactile experience**. I enjoy the rough texture of the pages and the smell of an old library, and no screen can copy that.

≈ **the feel of the pages** — sahifalar hissi

≈ **a sensory pleasure** — sezgilarga zavq beruvchi narsa

Qachon ishlatiladi: a tactile experience: qog'oz kitobning afzalligini aytishda. Part 1 dagi 'paper or e-books?' savoliga javob uchun; 'touchy experience' demang.

Namuna gap: For many readers, holding a real book is **a tactile experience** that an e-reader can't replace.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

50 digital distractions

7/10
SPEAKING BALL

raqamli chalg‘ituvchi narsalar • *things on phones or computers that take your attention away*

BAND 8 STORY

On a tablet, **digital distractions** are only one swipe away. I once began reading a novel and ended up replying to messages for an hour, so now I use a basic e-reader with no apps.

≈ **online interruptions** — internetdagi to‘siqlar

≈ **constant notifications** — uzluksiz bildirishnomalar

Qachon ishlatiladi: digital distractions: planshet va telefonda diqqatni buzadigan narsalar. ‘Be distracted by‘ bilan keladi. Part 3 da e-kitob kamchiligini aytishda.

Namuna gap: Reading on a phone invites **digital distractions**, whereas a paper book keeps me focused.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

Describe and explain

STRUCTURES 1 / 2

1 It was + X + that + clause

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

Aynan ... shu ... edi (ta'kidlash) • *A cleft sentence that puts the key information in focus*

BAND 8 STORY

It was the final chapter **that** made me cry, not the sad beginning. The author had spent the whole book building the characters, so the ending felt like losing real friends.

≈ **What made me cry was...** — Meni yig'latgan narsa ... edi

≈ **It's X that matters most** — Eng muhimi aynan X

Qachon ishlatiladi: Muhim so'zni ta'kidlash: It was + ot / payt / joy + that + gap. Gapni 'it was' bilan boshlab, ahamiyatli qismini ajratib ko'rsatadi; Part 2 da hikoyaga kuch beradi.

Namuna gap: **It was** my literature teacher **who** first made me fall in love with poetry.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

2 not so much A as B

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

A dan ko'ra ko'proq B • *Says that B describes something better than A*

BAND 8 STORY

The novel is **not so much** a love story **as** a portrait of a country after the war. That's why it stayed with me long after the final page.

≈ **more B than A** — A emas, ko'proq B

≈ **less A than B** — A dan ko'ra ko'proq B

Qachon ishlatiladi: not so much A as B: ikki narsani solishtirib, aniqroq xulosa chiqarish. Kitob yoki filmning asosiy mohiyatini aytishda juda foydali va Band 8 ga xos.

Namuna gap: To me, reading is **not so much** a hobby **as** a way of staying calm.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

3 Rarely/Seldom + auxiliary + S + V

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

Kamdan-kam hollarda ... • *An inverted structure used for emphasis with negative adverbs*

BAND 8 STORY

Rarely does a book make me laugh and cry on the same page, but this one managed it. I was reading on the metro, and a stranger asked whether I was okay.

≈ **Seldom do I...** — Men kamdan-kam hollarda ...

≈ **Never before had I...** — Hech qachon avval ... qilmagan edim

Qachon ishlatiladi: Rarely / Seldom / Never dan keyin yordamchi fe'l ega oldiga o'tadi: Rarely does a book..., Seldom have I... Kuchli ta'kid beradi va faqat ahamiyatli narsalar uchun ishlating.

Namuna gap: **Seldom do I** finish a novel in a single sitting, but this one was different.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

4 N + whose + noun + V

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

kimning / nimaning ... bo‘lgan ... • *A relative clause that shows possession*

BAND 8 STORY

It’s a novel by a young author **whose** previous book I had already loved, so I picked it up without even reading the blurb. That blind trust paid off.

≈ **N + of which + noun** — ... ning ... bo‘lgan

≈ **N, who + V,** — ..., u ... (qo‘shimcha izoh)

Qachon ishlatiladi: whose + ot: egalik ma’nosini bildirib, ikki gapni birlashtiradi: a writer whose books... ‘Who’s’ bilan adashtirmang, u ‘who is’ degani.

Namuna gap: I met a girl **whose** favourite hobby was collecting old books, and we talked for hours.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

5 Despite / In spite of + V-ing / noun

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

... ga qaramay • *Shows that something is true although there is a difficulty*

BAND 8 STORY

Despite being over six hundred pages long, the book never felt heavy. I finished it in a week, reading on buses and in queues.

≈ **Although + S + V** — ... bo‘lsa ham

≈ **Even though + S + V** — garchi ... bo‘lsa-da

Qachon ishlatiladi: Despite / In spite of + ot yoki V-ing (keyin gap emas!). ‘Despite of’ deb yozmang. Qiyinchilikka qaramay erishilgan natijani aytishda.

Namuna gap: **In spite of** having little free time, I read for twenty minutes every night.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

6 Whether + A or B, S + V

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

A bo‘lsin B bo‘lsin, ... • *Shows that something is true in either situation*

BAND 8 STORY

Whether you enjoy fantasy **or** realistic fiction, this book has something for you. My cousin hates reading, yet even he finished it in three days.

≈ **No matter what/who...** — Nima / kim bo‘lishidan qat’i nazar...

≈ **Regardless of...** — ... ga qaramay, ... dan qat’i nazar

Qachon ishlatiladi: Whether + A or B, gap: ikkala holatda ham natija o‘zgarmasligini bildiradi. Tavsiya berishda juda foydali: ‘Whether you like A or B, you’ll enjoy it’.

Namuna gap: **Whether** it’s a poem **or** a long novel, I always try to finish what I start.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

7 Hardly had + S + p.p. + when + S + V

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

... ulgurmay, ... boshlandi • *Says that one thing happened immediately after another*

BAND 8 STORY

Hardly had I read the first chapter **when** I knew I would finish the whole trilogy. I stayed up past midnight three nights in a row, which is not like me.

≈ **No sooner had... than...** — ... bilanoq ... boshlandi

≈ **As soon as + S + V** — ... bilanoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Hardly dan keyin Had + ega + p.p., keyin 'when' (yoki 'before') keladi. 'No sooner... than' bilan mazmuni bir xil; hikoya boshlanishini jonli qiladi.

Namuna gap: **Hardly had** the story **begun when** the whole class fell silent.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

8 Little did I know (that)...

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

Qayerdan ham bilardim, ... • *An inverted structure for something unexpected in a story*

BAND 8 STORY

Little did I know that a second-hand book from the bazaar would change my whole attitude to money. By the last chapter, I'd already started a small savings plan.

≈ **I had no idea that...** — ... ekanini bilmasdim

≈ **Who would have thought that...** — Kim ham o'ylardi ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Little did I know + (that) + gap: hikoyada kutilmagan voqeaning boshlanishini bildiradi. 'Little' dan keyin yordamchi fe'l oldinga chiqadi: Little did I know...

Namuna gap: **Little did I realise** that this book would become my favourite of the year.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

9 Having been + p.p., S + V

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

... qilingan bo'lgani uchun, ... • *A passive participle clause that explains the reason for an action*

BAND 8 STORY

Having been recommended by three different friends, the book felt like a challenge I couldn't ignore. So I ordered it that evening and read it in a weekend.

≈ **Since it had been + p.p.,** — ... bo'lganidan keyin

≈ **Being + p.p.,** — ... bo'lib turgani uchun

Qachon ishlatiladi: Having been + p.p. gapning egasi ish bajaruvchi emas, qabul qiluvchi bo'lganda ishlatiladi. Rasmiy va ixcham; Part 2 da ravon hikoya uchun.

Namuna gap: **Having been given** the book as a gift, I felt I had to finish it.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

10 used to / would + V

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

ilgari ... qilar edim (odat) • *Describes past habits and states that no longer happen*

BAND 8 STORY

I **used to** hate reading, and I **would** pretend to be busy whenever my teacher recommended a novel. Then a friend lent me a thriller, and everything changed.

≈ **I was in the habit of + V-ing** — ... qilish odatim bor edi

≈ **There was a time when I...** — ... qilgan paytlar bor edi

Qachon ishlatiladi: used to + V holat va odat uchun; would + V faqat takrorlanuvchi harakat uchun ('would be' holatda yaxshi emas). Bolalik va o'zgarishni hikoya qilishda ishlating.

Namuna gap: I **used to** read comics under my blanket, and my mother **would** pretend not to notice.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

11 Not until + clause + did + S + V

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

Faqat ... dan keyingina ... • *An inverted structure showing that something happened only after a point*

BAND 8 STORY

Not until I finished the last page **did** I realise that I'd been holding my breath. The ending was that tense, and I just sat there in silence for a minute.

≈ **It wasn't until... that...** — ... gacha emas, faqat shundan keyin ...

≈ **Only after + V-ing...** — Faqat ... dan keyin...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Not until + vaqt / gap + yordamchi fe'l + ega + V: 'Not until' dan keyingi bosh gapda tartib o'zgaradi. Bosh gapdagina inversiya bo'ladi, 'until' gapida emas.

Namuna gap: **Not until** I moved abroad **did** I appreciate how much my parents had taught me.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

12 It's high time + S + past simple

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

Endi ... payti keldi • *Says that something should happen now, and it is late already*

BAND 8 STORY

It's high time I read more in English instead of just studying grammar. So I've started a rule of twenty pages every night, and my vocabulary is already richer.

≈ **It's about time + S + V-ed** — Vaqti keldi ...

≈ **I really ought to + V** — Men albatta ... qilishim kerak

Qachon ishlatiladi: It's (high) time + ega + o'tgan zamon (ma'nosi hozirgi!). Kechikkan, lekin zarur ishni aytishda. 'It's time to + V' esa oddiyroq variant.

Namuna gap: **It's high time** schools **encouraged** students to read for pleasure, not just for exams.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

SAMPLE CUE CARD

Describe a book you recently read.

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You should say:

- what it was about
- why you chose it
- what you liked about it
- whether you would recommend it

My 1-minute notes

- The Alchemist • Paulo Coelho • shepherd Santiago
- recommended by a friend • second-hand copy • expected self-help
- poetic style • vivid desert scenes • relatable hero
- new perspective • fear of failure • follow your dreams
- short read • twenty pages a night • calming
- must-read • for anyone who feels stuck

SAMPLE ANSWER • BAND 8

I • Intro (what it was about)	I'd like to talk about The Alchemist by Paulo Coelho, which I finished a few weeks ago. It's about a young shepherd called Santiago who leaves Spain to chase a recurring dream about treasure near the Egyptian pyramids. It's a short novel, but it packs a lot of wisdom into its pages.
P • Why I chose it	I picked it up on the recommendation of a friend. Having heard her call it a must-read at least five times, I became curious and bought a second-hand copy at a Sunday book market. Honestly, I expected a dull self-help book, so I was pleasantly surprised.
P • What I liked	What I liked most was the simple, almost poetic style. The desert scenes are so vivid that I could picture every dune. On top of that, the main character is easy to relate to, because he doubts himself just as I do before big exams.
E • Reason 1	The first reason I'd recommend it is that it helped me see things from a different perspective. The more I read, the more I realised that fear of failure, not a lack of ability, was holding me back.
E • Reason 2	Secondly, it's a quick read, so it suits busy people. I read twenty pages every night, and it took my mind off my worries. Not until the last page did I realise how calm I felt.
W • Wrap-up (would I recommend it?)	So, all in all, I'd definitely recommend it to anyone who feels stuck. Were it not for that friend, I would never have discovered it, and I'm grateful she nudged me into trying it.

UPGRADE YOUR TALK

Tell a story, not a list

Instead of…	Say…
a good book	a gripping, thought-provoking read
I couldn't stop reading	I couldn't put it down
the story is surprising	the plot has an unexpected twist
an interesting story	a gripping plot
real characters	well-developed characters
I love reading	I'm an avid reader
I read for a long time	I got lost in the book
I read it all	I read it from cover to cover
I read it quickly	I skimmed through it
everybody says it's good	it came highly recommended
I liked it	it struck a chord with me
I learnt many things	it broadened my horizons
I learnt new words	it expanded my vocabulary
it was different from my idea	it changed my perspective
I forgot my problems	it took my mind off my worries
it was a true story	it was based on a true story
you must read it	it's an absolute must-read
it was boring	it failed to live up to my expectations
I bought an old book	I found a second-hand copy
I took a book from the library	I checked out a book from the library
people read less	there has been a steady decline in reading
people can't focus	attention spans are shrinking
parents should make kids read	parents should instil a love of reading
parents must show kids how	parents should lead by example
e-books are handy	an e-reader is a whole library in your pocket